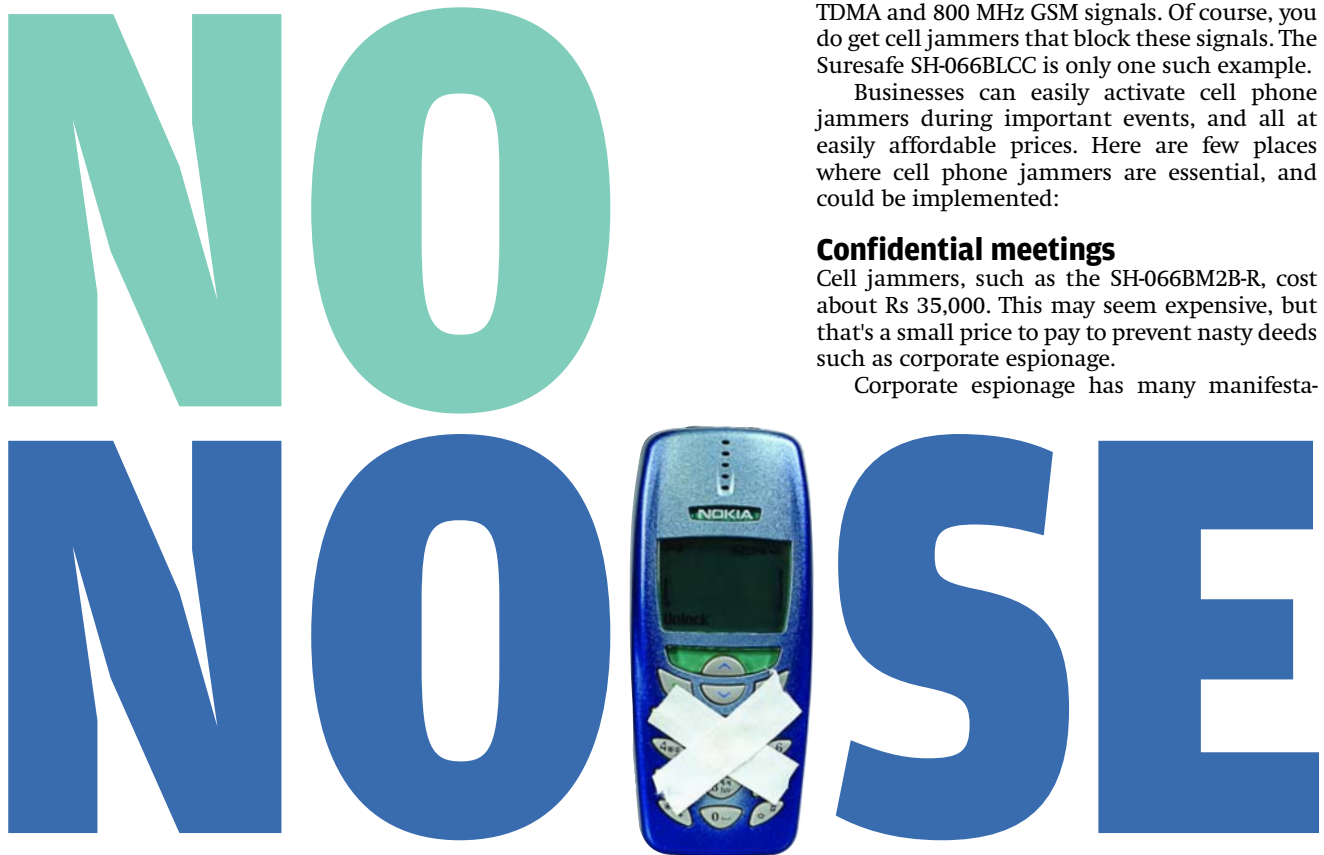


Etiquette demands the switching off of mobile phones in certain situations, but most people choose to ignore this. Here's how you can make sure that your business doesn't suffer because of the mobile menace



your phone dies on you. If you are within the range of a cell phone jammer, you will neither see any signal information on your handset, nor the name of your service provider. However, all calls coming to your phone will be diverted to a voicemail service—if you have activated this facility for your phone.

The cell jammer we reviewed—Suresafe SH-066BM2B-R—only blocks signals of the 900 and 1,800 MHz frequencies. It cannot block CDMA or TDMA and 800 MHz GSM signals. Of course, you do get cell jammers that block these signals. The Suresafe SH-066BLCC is only one such example.

Businesses can easily activate cell phone jammers during important events, and all at easily affordable prices. Here are few places where cell phone jammers are essential, and could be implemented:

Confidential meetings

Cell jammers, such as the SH-066BM2B-R, cost about Rs 35,000. This may seem expensive, but that's a small price to pay to prevent nasty deeds such as corporate espionage.

Corporate espionage has many manifesta-

Aliasgar Pardawala

Some months ago, in Mumbai, Hindi theatre actor Vikram Gokhale walked out of a play that he was performing in. The reason? Despite a request to the audience, from the play's actors and producers, to switch their cellular phones off, a phone did go off during the performance. It raised the hackles of the actor, who is one of the seniormost actors on Mumbai's Marathi theatre circuit. He returned to perform only after the man whose cell phone went off, apologised to Gokhale back stage.

Cellular phones, though equipped with enough potential to change the way we live our lives, can turn into major irritants. And it only takes an untimely call during a business conference, or inside a library, to remind us of the minor havoc it can create.

Enter Stage Right, cell phone jammers—devices that emit the same low frequency radio signals as cell phones, neutralising each other's signals. This means that your phone is unable to receive signals from your service provider's base station. Usually it takes a few seconds before

tions, and the Short Message Service (SMS) is surely one of the easiest ways to get information out of a locked board room—information, which could be a goldmine to your competitors, can filter out through a cell phone, without anyone even noticing it. The threat assumes greater significance because your rivals may know of

your decisions faster than your own employees.

Information can also be leaked out if someone dials the competitor's number, and keeps it connected while announcements are being made. This is smarter than SMS, and no one would ever be the wiser.

Hotels

Hotel owners can use cell phone jammers in and around their conference rooms, to prevent hosted seminars and conferences from being disturbed. A cell phone jammer will force people to exit the conference



The Suresafe SH-066BM2B-R cell jammer guarantees a no-ring zone